Entry routines

Establishing a purposeful start

Use the agreed BSCS entry routine to make the move from corridor to independent learning warm, predictable and purposeful. Students should know where to go, what to prepare and how to begin.

How to do it well

1 Prepare the start. Display the Do Now and have the required resources ready before students arrive.

2 Welcome from the threshold. Establish the agreed queue and entry expectations while monitoring the corridor and classroom.

3 Release to the task. Students go to allocated seats, prepare equipment and begin silently; start the timer from first entry.

4 Maintain the entry position. Greet students and monitor the developing routine until a critical mass is established, using brief precise corrections.

5 Secure independent thinking. Narrate successful actions, complete the register when settled and use the agreed signal before reviewing the Do Now.

What this sounds like

“Good morning. Equipment ready. Straight to your seat and begin the Do Now silently. You have four minutes.”

Classroom example. For a class arriving after lunch, the teacher displays four retrieval questions, has equipment ready and greets students at the threshold. The timer begins as the first pupils enter. Brief corrections address the exact entry action while the majority begin silently. The teacher moves into review only after using the agreed attention signal.

Top tips that make the technique work

Prepare before entry. Display a Do Now that students can start without an explanation and have resources ready.

Keep the threshold position. Welcome students while monitoring the corridor and the developing classroom routine until the class is established.

Start the timer from first entry. Use the agreed three-to-five-minute window and build productive urgency.

Narrate the useful action. Recognise students beginning the task, rather than making general comments about being good.

Rehearse the exact sticking point. If equipment or movement causes repeated delay, practise that component rather than changing the whole routine.

Do and avoid

Do	Avoid
Combine a warm greeting with clear expectations.	Using entry as an unplanned settling period.
Correct briefly and precisely while protecting the start.	Beginning an explanation while students are still moving or gathering equipment.

Further reading

Practitioner guidance; teacher language above is an illustrative BSCS adaptation.

DistillED - Solid Entry Routines | Barton - Embedding habits and routines